

30. Which one of the following is not commercial crop?

- (a) Sugarcane (b) Cotton
(c) Banana (d) Bajra

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Among the given crops, millet is not a commercial crop, whereas sugarcane, cotton and banana come under the category of commercial crops and are also called cash crops. However, it should be remembered that the level of commercialization of agriculture is different in different state. For example, in Haryana and Punjab, rice is a commercial crop but in Odisha it is a subsistence crop.

Food Crops

i. Rabi Crops

*In India, due to ecological differences in various regions different types of crop cycles are adopted. For example, rice and wheat in Punjab, Haryana, West U.P. etc. There are three different crop seasons in India –

Rabi Crops

Kharif Crops

Zaid Crops

*Rabi Crops are sown in winter between October and November and harvested in summer between March and April. Major Rabi crops are - **Wheat, Mustard, Potato, Gram, Pea, Lentil, Barley** etc. In winter, rainfalls due to temperate western disturbances help in the production of these crops.

*Wheat is the second most important food crops of India. It is produced in north and north-western regions. For the cultivation of wheat, the temperature should be between **10°C-25°C** and an average annual rainfall of **50 to 75 cm evenly distributed over the growing season** is required.

*According to Economic Survey data 2024-25, the cultivation of wheat in India is done on 31.8 Million Hectare (2023-24). Some important species of wheat are - **Sonalika, Arjun, Kundan, Amar (HW-2004), Bhawani (HW-1085), Chandrika (HPW-184), Deshratna (BR-104), Kanchan (DL-803), Gomti (K-9465)** etc. For the enhancement in production of wheat in India, **dwarf species** has been developed for wheat by agricultural scientists. In which Lerma Rojo 64-A, Sonora-63, Sonora-64, Mayo 64 and S-227 have been examined in wheat productive states of the Country.

*Due to the successful tests of dwarf species, the production of wheat has been increased. **Norin-10** is a gene of dwarfism in Wheat. **Macaroni wheat** is suitable for cultivation in dry condition or unirrigated area. Kalyan Sona (Kalyan Gold) is an advanced type of wheat species.

***Yellow rust, Brown rust and Black rust** are three types of rust diseases found in wheat.

***Karnal Bunt** is a fungal disease of wheat. This disease occurs from **Tilletia Indica Fungi**. The disease was first recognized in the year 1931.

***Tirtikale** is a hybrid of wheat and rye.

*According to 2023-24 data, **Uttar Pradesh** (35.34 million tonnes) is the largest producer of wheat. Madhya Pradesh (22.58 million tonnes) and Punjab (17.74 million tonnes) are placed at second and third position respectively.

1. In which months is the Rabi crop sown?

- (a) March-April (b) June-July
(c) October-November (d) January-February

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

On the basis of seasons, the crops in India have been divided into three types.

Kharif crops: The Kharif crop is the summer crop or monsoon crop in India. Kharif crops are usually sown with the beginning of the first rains i.e in June- July and harvested in October - November.

Major Kharif crops of India include Millets (Bajra & Jowar), Cotton, Soyabean, Sugarcane, Turmeric, Paddy (Rice), Maize, Moong (Pulses), Groundnut, Red Chillies, etc.

Rabi Crops: The Rabi crop is the spring harvest or winter crop in India. It is sown in October-November last and harvested in March-April every year. Major Rabi crops in India include Wheat, Barley, Mustard, Sesame, Peas, Potatoes.

Zaid Crop: This crop is grown in some parts of the country from March to July. Prominent examples are Muskmelon, Watermelon, Vegetables of Cucurbitaceae family such as bitter gourd, pumpkin, ridged gourd, etc.

2. Which of the following is a "Rabi" crop :

- (a) Cotton (b) Maize
(c) Tur (d) Mustard

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Rabi crops are sown :

- (a) From October to November
(b) From December to March